The Noble Great Vehicle Sūtra called The Questions of the Householder Ugra

Āryagṛhapati-ugraparipṛcchā-nāma-mahāyānasūtra · Toh 63 · Derge Kangyur
འཕགས་པ་ཁྱིམ་བདག་དྲག་ཤུལ་ཅན་གཞི་ཞུས་པ་ཞེས་བ་བྱ་ཐེག་པ་ཆེན་པོའི་མདོ།

The Noble Great Vehicle Sūtra called The Questions of the Householder Ugra, known in Sanskrit as the Āryagṛhapati Ugraparipṛcchā Nāma Mahāyānasūtra and in Tibetan as Phakpa Khyimdak Drakshulchen Gyi Zhupa, is a Mahāyāna sūtra in which the Buddha, staying at Śrāvastī in Prince Jeta's Grove with a great assembly of monks and bodhisattvas such as Maitreya, Mañjuśrī, and Avalokiteśvara, responds to the questions of the householder Ugra. Its teachings concern the bodhisattva path and how it may be practiced both by those who live as householders and by those who have gone forth into the renunciant life, setting out the conduct and ideals proper to each. The text is Toh 63 in the Kangyur, where it belongs to the sūtra class. It is the nineteenth chapter of the Great Heap of Jewels, the Ratnakūṭa collection of Mahāyāna discourses.

From the noble Great Heap of Jewels, the Dharma discourse in one hundred thousand chapters, the nineteenth chapter: The Questions of the Householder Ugra. The first scroll.

In the language of India: āryagṛhapati ugraparipṛcchā nāma mahāyānasūtra. In the language of Tibet: The Noble Great Vehicle Sūtra called The Questions of the Householder Ugra.

Homage to all the buddhas and bodhisattvas.

Thus did I hear at one time. The Blessed One (the Buddha) was staying at Śrāvastī, in Prince Jeta's Grove, the park of Anāthapiṇḍada. He was there together with a great saṅgha of one thousand two hundred and fifty monks, and with five thousand bodhisattvas, great beings, among them Maitreya, Mañjuśrī, Sarvāpāyañjaha, Avalokiteśvara, and Mahāsthāmaprāpta. At that time the Blessed One was surrounded by many hundreds of thousands in his assembly, and he faced them and taught the Dharma. He fully revealed the holy life, virtuous in the beginning, virtuous in the middle, and virtuous in the end, excellent in meaning and excellent in wording, unadulterated, complete, wholly pure, and wholly purified.

Then the householder Ugra came out of the great city of Śrāvastī with five hundred servants. He went to Prince Jeta's Grove, Anāthapiṇḍada's park,

where the Blessed One was. When he arrived, he bowed his head at the Blessed One's feet, circled the Blessed One three times, and sat down to one side.

Likewise other householders also came: the householder Lover of Joy, the householder Lover of Fame, the householder Sudatta, the householder Joy-Maker, the householder Yaśodatta, the householder Sudhana, the householder Delighting in Conduct, the householder Anāthapiṇḍada, the householder Nāgaśrī, and the householder Delighting in Truth. These and very many other householders, each with five hundred servants, came out of the great city of Śrāvastī. They went to Prince Jeta's Grove, Anāthapiṇḍada's park, where the Blessed One was. When they arrived, they bowed their heads at the Blessed One's feet, circled the Blessed One three times, and sat down to one side. Nearly all of these householders, together with their servants, had genuinely entered the Great Vehicle, had generated roots of virtue, and were certain to attain unsurpassed, perfect and complete awakening.

Then the householder Ugra, knowing that the great assembly of householders had gathered, rose from his seat through the power of the Blessed One. He draped his upper robe over one shoulder, placed his right knee on the ground, bowed toward the Blessed One with palms joined, and said this to the Blessed One:

"If the Blessed One will give me the opportunity to ask a question and have it answered, I would ask the Blessed One, the Tathāgata, the Arhat, the perfectly complete Buddha, about a certain matter."

When he had said this, the Blessed One said this to the householder Ugra: "Householder, the Tathāgata always gives you the opportunity. Householder, ask the Tathāgata whatever you wish, and by answering each thing you ask, I shall satisfy your mind."

When this had been said, the householder Ugra said this to the Blessed One: "Blessed One, there are sons of good family or daughters of good family who have generated the mind set on unsurpassed, perfect and complete awakening; who are devoted to the Great Vehicle, established in the Great Vehicle, wish to accomplish the Great Vehicle, wish to enter the Great Vehicle, and have pledged themselves to the Great Vehicle; who wish to put on armor in order to care for all beings, to bring relief to all beings, and to protect all beings; who take up a great burden for the sake of all beings, thinking, 'I will bring across those who have not crossed over, free those who are not freed,

bring relief to those who have not found relief, and lead to complete nirvāṇa those who have not passed into complete nirvāṇa'; who are established in a great and vast undertaking; who, having heard of the immeasurable wisdom of the buddhas, wish to put on armor in order to accomplish that wisdom; and who, though they know the many faults of the suffering of saṃsāra, do not grow weary at heart, and whose minds do not become discouraged even though they cycle through countless eons.

"Blessed One, among these sons or daughters of good family who belong to the bodhisattva vehicle, there are some who have gone forth from the household, who accomplish the factors conducive to awakening and do not live in a house. There are also some who live in a house and accomplish the factors conducive to awakening, but do not go forth from the household.

"That being so, Blessed One, out of compassion for the world with its gods, humans and asuras, in order to sustain this Great Vehicle, to keep the lineage of the Three Jewels from being cut off, and to make omniscient wisdom long endure, may the Blessed One please explain well the presentation of the qualities of training for householder bodhisattvas: how a householder bodhisattva, remaining at the level of a householder, acts in accordance with the command of the tathāgatas and does not decline, does not decline at all, from the factors conducive to awakening, so that in this life he is free of blameworthy deeds and in other lives too he goes on to distinction.

"And, Blessed One, as for those bodhisattvas who have gone forth from the household, who have given up what is pleasing and what is displeasing, shaved off their hair and beards, put on saffron robes, and with genuine faith gone forth from home into homelessness, please explain fully, by way of both instruction and further teaching, how far their practice of the Dharma and their practice of virtue extend. How should householder bodhisattvas and renunciant bodhisattvas live? How should they practice?"

When he had said this, the Blessed One said this to the householder Ugra:

"Excellent, householder, excellent! That you think to ask me about this matter is in keeping with your character. Therefore listen well and carefully, and bear it in mind. I shall explain to you how householder bodhisattvas and renunciant bodhisattvas should properly take up the qualities of the training and abide in supreme conduct, and how they should practice."

"So be it, Blessed One," he replied, and the householder Ugra listened to the Blessed One. The Blessed One then said this to him:

"Householder, a householder bodhisattva who lives in the household should go for refuge to the Buddha. He should go for refuge to the Dharma. He should go for refuge to the Saṅgha. He should dedicate the root of virtue of having gone for refuge to these three to unsurpassed, perfect and complete awakening.

"Householder, how does a householder bodhisattva go for refuge to the Buddha? Householder, a householder bodhisattva forms the resolve, thinking, 'I shall bring to completion the body of a buddha, well adorned with the thirty-two marks of a great being,' and he exerts diligence in order to accomplish fully those roots of virtue by which the thirty-two marks of a great being are accomplished. In this way, householder, a bodhisattva goes for refuge to the Buddha.

"Householder, how does a householder bodhisattva go for refuge to the Dharma? Householder, a householder bodhisattva is respectful toward the Dharma and honors it. He seeks the Dharma as his aim, longs for the Dharma, rejoices in and is devoted to delight in the Dharma, inclines toward the Dharma, tends toward the Dharma, is bent upon the Dharma, protects the Dharma, abides guarding the Dharma, abides in the renown of the Dharma and in the conduct of the Dharma, comes under the sway of the Dharma, seeks the Dharma thoroughly, is endowed with the power of the Dharma, is armed with the weapon of the gift of the Dharma, and does the work of the Dharma. Endowed with such qualities, he gains the mindful thought: 'Once I have fully awakened to unsurpassed, perfect and complete awakening, I shall share out the Dharma, in accordance with the Dharma, to the world with its gods, humans and asuras.' In this way, householder, a householder bodhisattva goes for refuge to the Dharma.

"Householder, how does a householder bodhisattva go for refuge to the Saṅgha? Householder, a householder bodhisattva's going for refuge to the Saṅgha is this: if he sees monks who are stream-enterers, once-returners, non-returners or arhats, or ordinary people, or followers of the Śrāvaka Vehicle, the Pratyekabuddha Vehicle or the Great Vehicle, he is respectful and deferential toward them, eager to rise for them, and receives their words gladly and agreeably. He gains the mindful thought: 'By serving those who have rightly gone and rightly entered, once I have fully awakened to unsurpassed, perfect and complete awakening, I too shall teach the Dharma so that the qualities of the śrāvakas may be accomplished and the qualities of the pratyekabuddhas may be accomplished.' He is respectful and deferential

toward them, and he does not act with displeasure toward them. In this way, householder, a householder bodhisattva goes for refuge to the Saṅgha.

"Furthermore, householder, a householder bodhisattva who possesses four qualities has gone for refuge to the Buddha. What are the four? He does not abandon the awakening mind, he does not break his commitment, he does not give up great compassion, and he does not aim at any other vehicle. Householder, a householder bodhisattva who possesses these four qualities has gone for refuge to the Buddha.

"Furthermore, householder, a householder bodhisattva who possesses four qualities has gone for refuge to the Dharma. What are the four? Relying on and attending upon persons who speak the Dharma, serving them and honoring them, he listens to the Dharma; having heard the Dharma, he examines it properly; he teaches to others as well the teachings just as he has heard them and just as he has understood them, and explains them correctly and thoroughly; and he dedicates the root of virtue arising from the gift of the Dharma to unsurpassed, perfect and complete awakening. Householder, a householder bodhisattva who possesses these four qualities has gone for refuge to the Dharma.

"Furthermore, householder, a householder bodhisattva who possesses four qualities has gone for refuge to the Saṅgha. What are the four? He introduces followers of the Śrāvaka Vehicle who have entered the flawless state into the mind set on omniscience; he leads those who gather others by material things to gather them by the Dharma; he relies on the Saṅgha of irreversible bodhisattvas and not on the Saṅgha of śrāvakas; and although he seeks the qualities of the śrāvakas, he is not devoted to their liberation. Householder, a householder bodhisattva who possesses these four qualities has gone for refuge to the Saṅgha.

"Furthermore, householder, when a householder bodhisattva sees an image of the Tathāgata and gains recollection of the Buddha, that is going for refuge to the Buddha. When he hears the Dharma and gains recollection of the Dharma, that is going for refuge to the Dharma. When he sees the Tathāgata's Saṅgha of śrāvakas and recollects the awakening mind, that is going for refuge to the Saṅgha.

"Furthermore, householder, when a householder bodhisattva living in the household gives gifts with the aspiration to keep company with buddhas, that is going for refuge to the Buddha. When he gives gifts in order to protect the

sacred Dharma, that is going for refuge to the Dharma. When he dedicates that giving to unsurpassed, perfect and complete awakening, that is going for refuge to the Saṅgha.

"Furthermore, householder, a householder bodhisattva living in the household does the deeds of a good person and does not do the deeds of a bad person. Householder, what are the deeds of a good person, and not the deeds of a bad person? Householder, a householder bodhisattva seeks wealth by lawful means, not by unlawful means. He seeks it fairly, not unfairly.

He makes his living by right livelihood, not by wrong livelihood. He does not use the wealth he has gained in accordance with the Dharma to harm others. He cultivates the perception of impermanence again and again, and he takes the essence. That is, he honors and serves his father and mother, and he properly provides for his children, his wife, his male and female servants, his workers and his hired laborers. He shows respect to his friends, ministers, relatives and kinsmen. In every case he increases his giving by bringing them into the Dharma.

Furthermore, householder, a lay bodhisattva exerts himself so as to honor the burden he has taken up, namely, by carrying the burden of the five aggregates of all sentient beings. He exerts himself so as to honor the burden he has taken up, namely, by not rejecting the vehicles of the śrāvakas and the pratyekabuddhas.

He never tires of bringing sentient beings to maturity. He is not attached to his own happiness. He brings all sentient beings to happiness. Because he is not shaken by gain and loss, fame and obscurity, praise and blame, pleasure and pain, he wholly transcends the worldly dharmas. He is not arrogant because of gain and abundant wealth. He does not lose heart when he lacks gain, fame, and a good name. He acts only after careful examination. He guards right practice. He takes no pleasure in wrong practice. With a mind that does not dwell, he sees whatever arises. He does not have a mind like drifting cotton. He fulfills his promises just as he made them. He does what others need done and lets go of his own concerns. He expects no return for what he has done for others. He bears no grudge for harm done to him. He is grateful and acknowledges what has been done for him. He does good deeds. He distributes wealth to the poor. He breaks the pride of the powerful. He comforts the frightened with fearlessness. He removes the arrow of grief from those stricken by grief. He is patient with the weak and accepts them. He gives

up pride, and even the pride that goes beyond pride. He is respectful to his teachers. He attends on the learned. He questions the wise. His view is straight. He acts without guile. He is without deceit. He has unfeigned loving-kindness toward all sentient beings. He is insatiable in seeking out what is virtuous. He is never satisfied with learning. He is firm in his resolve in what he has undertaken. He keeps company with noble persons. He has great compassion for those who are not noble. He is steadfast in friendship. He is even-minded toward friend and foe. He has no closed teacher's fist with regard to any of the qualities of a buddha. He teaches the dharmas just as he has heard them. He contemplates the meaning of what he has heard.

He perceives all the delights and amusements of sense pleasure as impermanent. He perceives the body as impure. He perceives life as like a drop of dew. He perceives wealth as like an illusion and a mirage. He perceives his children and wife as the Avīci hell. He perceives fields, household work and the acquisition of all kinds of clothing as the misery of want. He perceives the pursuit of these as the destruction of the roots of virtue. He perceives the household as like an executioner. He perceives his friends, ministers, relatives and kinsmen as the guardians of hell. He perceives that day and night he must assess, asking, "What progress have I made?" He perceives that he must take the essence from the body that has no essence. He perceives that he must take the essence from the life that has no essence. He perceives that he must take the essence from the wealth that has no essence.

What, then, is the perception that one must take the essence from the body that has no essence? It is being eager to do whatever others need done, speaking respectfully to one's teachers, bowing to them, rising for them, joining one's palms, and performing acts of reverence. This is called the perception that one must take the essence from the body that has no essence.

What, then, is the perception that one must take the essence from the life that has no essence? It is not letting the roots of virtue one has previously planted decline, and making them increase still further. This is called the perception that one must take the essence from the life that has no essence.

What, then, is the perception that one must take the essence from the wealth that has no essence? It is subduing the miserly mind, increasing the mind of great giving, and properly dispensing gifts. This is called the perception that one must take the essence from the wealth that has no essence.

Thus, householder, a lay bodhisattva performs these deeds of a holy person, and not the deeds of a bad person. When he acts in this way, the tathāgatas do not find fault with him; he is one who speaks what is right, one who speaks the Dharma. That is, the vow he made in the past to attain unsurpassed, perfect and complete awakening does not decline; it does not decline in the least.

Furthermore, householder, a lay bodhisattva takes up all the bases of training. That is, having taken up the five bases of training, he should give up killing. He should lay down the stick and lay down weapons, have a sense of shame, be endowed with compassion, be by nature harmless toward all living creatures and beings, be even-minded toward all sentient beings, and always abide in loving-kindness.

He should give up taking what is not given. He should be content with his own wealth, take no delight in the wealth of others, be free of craving and covetousness, have no desire for the riches of others, and not take what is not given, not even so much as a blade of grass or a leaf.

He should give up sexual misconduct. He should be content with his own wife, have no desire for the wives of others, look with eyes free of attachment, keep a mind of disenchantment, and strive to reflect without attachment, thinking, "Sense pleasures bring great suffering."

Whenever thoughts of desire for his own wife arise, then too, since he has come under the power of the afflictions, he should regard his own wife as unattractive and engage in sensual pleasure with an apprehensive mind, not while gripped by attachment, perceiving it as impermanent, as suffering, as without self, and as impure. He thinks: "Since I should not indulge in desire even in thought, how much less should there be the joining of the two organs, or entry into what is not the proper orifice! I shall not act in that way."

He should give up false speech. He should speak truthfully, speak correctly, act just as he has spoken, be undeceiving, be of excellent intention, and be endowed with mindfulness and vigilance. Speaking just as he has seen and heard, and guarding the Dharma, he should not knowingly tell a lie even for the sake of his body and his life.

He should give up grain liquor, mixed liquor, and intoxicating drinks. He should be free of drunkenness, free of intoxication, free of confusion; he should not babble, not be haughty, not be giddy, not be distracted, but should keep mindfulness closely established and be endowed with vigilance. When the

resolve to give away everything he owns arises in him, and he thinks, "I should give food to those who want food and drink to those who want drink," then he may give liquor to others as well. He should give rise to this thought: "This is the occasion for the perfection of giving. Since the time has come to give whatever is wanted to whoever wants it, I shall act thus: to whomever I give liquor in this way, I will lead each of them to hold rightly to mindfulness and vigilance, in conduct free of confusion." And why is that? Because fulfilling every wish is the bodhisattva's complete practice of the perfection of giving. Householder, in this way, even if a householder bodhisattva gives liquor to others, he is not faulted by the tathāgatas.

Householder, that householder bodhisattva should also dedicate the root of virtue from taking up the five precepts to unsurpassed, perfect, complete awakening. He should guard those five precepts very carefully as well. He should never engage in slander, and he should reconcile those who are divided. He should not speak harshly; he should speak gently, with soft words, and honestly. He should not engage in idle talk; he should speak at the right time, speak truly, speak what is meaningful, speak the Dharma, speak what is reasonable, speak of discipline, answer well, and act just as he has spoken. He should not be covetous, but should think of the benefit and happiness of all sentient beings. He should not harbor malice, but should always put on the armor of the power of patience. He should see correctly and be free of all wrong and mistaken views. As his god, his mind should follow the Buddha, and he should not adopt any other god.

Householder, furthermore, in whatever village, town, market town, region, or district the householder bodhisattva lives, there he should speak on the Dharma to sentient beings. Those without faith he should draw into faith. Those sentient beings who are irreverent, who do not honor their fathers, do not honor their mothers, do not honor śramaṇas, do not honor brahmins, do not serve the heads of their families, who lack propriety and overstep the bounds, he should draw into reverence for teachers and into the practice of the Dharma. Those sentient beings who have little learning he should direct toward great learning. The miserly he should draw into giving, the immoral into moral discipline, the malicious into patience and gentleness, the lazy into undertaking diligence, the forgetful into mindfulness and vigilance, and those of corrupt understanding into wisdom. He should share his wealth with poor sentient beings. He should give medicine to sick sentient beings. He should be a protector for sentient beings without a protector, a refuge for those without

refuge, and an ally for those without allies. He should guard all those regions and districts by means of the Dharma, in harmony with them all, in such a way that no sentient being falls into wrong ways.

Householder, if, though the householder bodhisattva has instructed sentient beings once, twice, three times, up to seven times, establishing them in good qualities, they do not come to abide in any good quality at all, then, householder, that householder bodhisattva should generate great compassion for those sentient beings. He should put on the firm armor of omniscience and declare these words: "As long as these hard-to-tame, unruly sentient beings have not been brought to maturity, for that long I shall not fully awaken into unsurpassed, perfect, complete awakening." And why is that? He thinks: "I have put on the armor for their sake. It is not for the sake of upright beings, not for the sake of those without guile, not for the sake of those without deceit, not for the sake of those endowed with moral discipline; I did not put on the armor for the sake of those endowed with good qualities. I shall act in such a way that my effort bears fruit, and that sentient beings, as soon as they see me, gain joy and faith. Thus I shall practice; thus I shall exert diligence."

Householder, if in whatever village, town, market town, region, or district the bodhisattva lives, sentient beings are born in any of the lower realms because he did not exhort them or did not remind them, that bodhisattva is censured by the tathāgatas. Householder, it is like this: if a skilled physician lives in some village, town, market town, region, or district, and he is unable to cure the poisoning of even a few sentient beings, so that they die, that physician will be blamed by many people.

"Householder, in the same way, suppose a bodhisattva lives in some village, town, market town, region, or district. If even a few beings in that area, never urged on or reminded by him, are reborn in any of the lower realms, that bodhisattva is reproached by the tathāgatas.

"Therefore, householder, wherever a householder bodhisattva lives, whether in a village, town, market town, region, or district, he should put on this armor, thinking: 'I shall act so that not a single being falls into ruin. This I shall accomplish. To this end I shall set about my effort with diligence.'

"Furthermore, householder, a householder bodhisattva who lives at home should become skilled in the faults of household life. He should examine it in this way. What is called a home destroys the roots of virtue. It ruins whatever has come into being. It fells the trunk of virtue. That is why it is called a home.

"What is called living at home is the abode of all the afflictions. It is the abode of conceptual thoughts rooted in nonvirtue. It is the abode of childish, ordinary people who are untamed and unguarded. It is the abode of those who practice nonvirtue. It is a gathering of bad people. That is why it is called living at home.

"What is called living at home is said to be the abode of every state of suffering. It makes the roots of virtue cultivated in the past decline. That is why it is called living at home.

"What is called a home is the place where, living there, one does what should not be done. Living there, one does not show respect to father and mother, to śramaṇas, or to brahmins. That is why it is called a home.

"What is called a home is where, because one delights in the creeper of existence, sorrow, lamentation, suffering, unhappiness, and turmoil arise. That is why it is called a home.

"What is called a home is where killing, binding, beating, threatening, and harming gather, together with harsh, abusive, disparaging, and malicious ways of speech. That is why it is called a home.

"What is called a home does not plant roots of virtue not yet planted. It destroys the roots of virtue already planted. It is reproached by the wise, by the buddhas, and by all the śrāvakas of the buddhas. One who lives in it goes to the lower realms. One who lives in it takes the wrong course out of desire, takes the wrong course out of aversion, fear, and delusion. That is why it is called a home.

"It does not guard the whole aggregate of moral discipline. It casts away the aggregate of meditative absorption. It does not enter into the aggregate of wisdom. It does not attain the aggregate of liberation. It does not give rise to the aggregate of the knowledge and vision of liberation. That is why it is called a home.

"Living at home is craving for father, mother, son, and wife, for male and female slaves, workers and hired laborers, friends, ministers, relatives, blood kin, and a household of servants.

"Living at home is as hard to fill as the ocean is with streams.

"Living at home is as insatiable as fire is with wood.

"Living at home is endless conceptual thought, endless as the wind.

"Living at home perishes, as a city of sand perishes.

"Living at home is tainted, as fine food is tainted when mixed with poison.

"Living at home is constant suffering, because like an enemy it is never in harmony.

"Living at home obstructs the practice of the Dharma of the noble ones.

"Living at home is quarreling with one another over circumstances.

"Living at home is constant discord, because each intends harm to the other.

"Living at home is full of harm, because one engages in courses of action both good and bad.

"Living at home is unceasing toil, because there is no end to the work.

"Living at home is impermanent, because what has been gathered over a long time is bound to perish.

"Living at home is suffering, because one must search for possessions and guard them.

"Living at home is constant anxiety, because it is hostile like an enemy.

"Living at home is heedlessness, because one is in the grip of the inverted views.

"Living at home is like an actor's painted makeup, because it is fashioned by one's own imagining and is empty of essential nature.

"Living at home ends in decline and change, because people are quickly parted from one another.

"Living at home is like watching an illusion, because people come together only for a while and have no essential nature at all.

"Living at home is like a dream, because all prosperity ends in decline.

"Living at home is like a drop of dew, because it quickly passes away.

"Living at home is like a drop of honey, because one tastes only a little sweetness.

"Living at home is like a net of thorns, because one is tormented by forms, sounds, smells, tastes, tangible objects, and mental objects.

"Living at home is like a creature with a mouth the size of a needle's eye, because one never wearies of thoughts of nonvirtue.

"Living at home destroys life, because people deceive one another.

"Living at home is constant turmoil, because it makes the mind turbid.

"Living at home is held in common, because it can be destroyed by kings, by thieves, by fire, by water, and by heirs who take their shares.

"Living at home has little sweetness, because its drawbacks are many.

"In this way, householder, a householder bodhisattva who lives at home should become skilled in the faults of household life.

"Furthermore, householder, a householder bodhisattva who lives at home should practice much giving, self-taming, perfect restraint, and observance. He should also reflect in this way: What is given away is mine; what is kept at home is not mine. What is given away has substance; what is kept at home has no substance. What is given away brings happiness hereafter; what is kept at home brings happiness only for the present. What is given away need not be guarded.

What is kept at home must be guarded. What is given brings craving to an end; what is kept at home makes craving grow. What is given is free of any sense of "mine"; what is kept at home comes with a sense of "mine." What is given is not clung to; what is kept at home comes with clinging. What is given is free of fear; what is kept at home comes with fear. What is given points the way to the path of awakening; what is kept at home points the way to the side of Māra. What is given is inexhaustible; what is kept at home will be used up. What is given is happiness; what is kept at home is suffering, because it must be guarded constantly. What is given leads to the abandonment of the afflictions; what is in the home makes the afflictions increase. What is given leads to great wealth; what is kept at home does not lead to great wealth. What is given is the deed of a holy person; what is kept at home is the deed of a base person. What is given is praised by all the buddhas; what is kept at home is praised by childish people. That is how one should reflect. Householder, in this way the householder bodhisattva should take hold of what is of real value.

Moreover, householder, when a householder bodhisattva sees a beggar, he should give rise to three perceptions. What are the three? The perception of him as a spiritual friend, the perception that this will lead to great wealth in a future life, and the perception that he points the way to the path of awakening. Householder, when a householder bodhisattva sees a beggar, he should give

rise to these three perceptions.

Moreover, householder, when a householder bodhisattva sees a beggar, he should give rise to three perceptions. What are the three? The perception of cutting off avarice, the perception of giving away all one's possessions, and the perception of looking toward the wisdom of omniscience. Householder, when a householder bodhisattva sees a beggar, he should give rise to these three perceptions.

Moreover, householder, when a householder bodhisattva sees a beggar, he should give rise to three perceptions. What are the three? The perception of acting in accordance with the command of the Tathāgata, the perception of defeating Māra, and the perception of not hoping for karmic maturation. Householder, when a householder bodhisattva sees a beggar, he should give rise to these three perceptions.

Moreover, householder, when a householder bodhisattva sees a beggar, he should give rise to three perceptions. What are the three? The perception of the beggar as a servant, the perception that through the means of attraction he will not be abandoned, and the perception of emerging from clinging to what is ignoble. Householder, when a householder bodhisattva sees a beggar, he should give rise to these three perceptions.

Moreover, householder, when a householder bodhisattva sees a beggar, he should give rise to three perceptions. What are the three? The perception of being free of attachment, the perception of cultivating loving-kindness, and the perception of not entering into delusion. Householder, when a householder bodhisattva sees a beggar, he should give rise to these three perceptions.

And why is that? Householder, it is because when a householder bodhisattva sees a beggar, his attachment, aversion, and delusion become thin. Householder, how is it that when a householder bodhisattva sees a beggar, his attachment, aversion, and delusion become thin? His being indifferent toward the thing and giving it away: this is the thinning of his attachment. His cultivating loving-kindness toward those beggars: this is the thinning of his aversion. His dedicating to unsurpassed, perfect awakening after he has given the thing: this is the thinning of his delusion. Householder, it is in this way that when a householder bodhisattva sees a beggar, his attachment, aversion, and delusion become thin.

Moreover, householder, when a householder bodhisattva sees a beggar, his cultivation of the six perfections becomes complete. Householder, here, the

moment a householder bodhisattva is asked for anything at all, his mind does not cling to that thing. In this way his cultivation of the perfection of generosity becomes complete. He gives it away in reliance on the awakening mind. In this way his cultivation of the perfection of moral discipline becomes complete. He cultivates loving-kindness toward those beggars and is neither angry nor ill-willed. In this way his cultivation of the perfection of patience becomes complete. He is not discouraged by the wavering of mind that thinks, "If I give this away, what will I have to use?" In this way his cultivation of the perfection of diligence becomes complete. He gives to the beggar, and having given, he feels no distress and no regret; he is delighted and thoroughly pleased in every respect, giving rise to bliss and mental happiness, and he gives while abiding in the awakening mind. In this way his cultivation of the perfection of meditative concentration becomes complete. Having given, he does not apprehend any phenomenon and does not hope for karmic maturation; just as the wise are not attached to any phenomenon at all, so, free of attachment, he dedicates it to unsurpassed, perfect awakening. In this way his cultivation of the Perfection of Wisdom becomes complete. Householder, it is in this way that when a householder bodhisattva sees a beggar, his cultivation of the six perfections becomes complete.

The second fascicle.

Moreover, householder, a householder bodhisattva living at home, being free of attachment and anger, should attain equanimity toward the eight worldly concerns. Whether he gains wealth, gains a wife, gains sons, gains riches, or gains grain, he should not become puffed up, nor should he be elated. And even if none of these come to him, he should not become discouraged, nor should he be dejected. He should reflect in this way: all conditioned things are made like a magical illusion; their defining characteristic is that, being fabricated, they appear each in its own way.

Namely, father and mother, son, wife, male servants, female servants, workers, hired laborers, friends, ministers, relatives, and kin by blood all come about through the maturation of karma. They are not mine, and I am not theirs. Why is that? Because father, mother, and the rest are not my protector, my refuge, my ally, my shelter, or my island; they are not my self, nor do they belong to me.

If even the appropriated aggregates, elements, and sense sources are not my self and do not belong to me, what need is there to speak of my father,

mother, and the rest becoming my self or mine, or of my belonging to them? Why is that? Because I am the owner of my karma and the heir to my share of karma. Whatever karma I have done, virtuous or sinful, that very share I will inherit. I experience the fruit of that very deed individually, and I undergo the maturation of that very deed. These others too are owners of their karma and heirs to their share of karma. Whatever karma they have done, virtuous or sinful, that very share they will inherit. They will individually experience the maturation of that very deed, and they will individually experience its fruit.

Therefore, for their sake, it is not my part to accumulate nonvirtuous karma. They are what I hold as mine for happiness in this life, but they are not what I hold as mine for happiness in other lives. I should devote myself to what is truly mine, namely generosity, self-discipline, restraint, patience, gentleness, diligence, heedfulness, and the virtue that gathers and accomplishes the factors of awakening. That virtue is mine, for on whatever path I go, these too will go along with me.

Thinking in this way, he does not accumulate sinful karma even for the sake of his own life, let alone for the sake of son and wife.

Householder, the lay bodhisattva living at home should give rise to three perceptions toward his own wife. What are the three? The perception of impermanence, the perception of instability, and the perception of change. Householder, the lay bodhisattva should give rise to these three perceptions toward his own wife.

Furthermore, householder, the lay bodhisattva should give rise to three perceptions toward his own wife. What are the three? He thinks: "She is a companion for pleasure and play, but she is not a companion in the world beyond. She is a companion for eating and drinking, but she is not a companion in experiencing the maturation of karma. She is a companion in happiness, but she is not a companion in suffering." Householder, the lay bodhisattva should give rise to these three perceptions toward his own wife.

Furthermore, householder, the lay bodhisattva should give rise to three perceptions toward his own wife. What are the three? The perception of her as impure, the perception of her as foul-smelling, and the perception of her as disagreeable.

Furthermore, householder, the lay bodhisattva should give rise to three perceptions toward his own wife. What are the three? The perception of her as an enemy, the perception of her as an executioner, and the perception of her

as an adversary.

Furthermore, householder, the lay bodhisattva should give rise to three perceptions toward his own wife. What are the three? The perception of her as a piśācī, the perception of her as a rākṣasī, and the perception of her as of ugly form.

Furthermore, householder, the lay bodhisattva should give rise to three perceptions toward his own wife. What are the three? The perception of her as hard to satisfy, the perception of her as a bottomless depth, and the perception of her as ungrateful.

Furthermore, householder, the lay bodhisattva should give rise to three perceptions toward his own wife. What are the three? The perception of going to the hells, the perception of going to birth as an animal, and the perception of going to the world of Yama.

Furthermore, householder, the lay bodhisattva should give rise to three perceptions toward his own wife. What are the three? The perception of her as a burden, the perception of her as existence, and the perception of her as the grasping of existence.

Furthermore, householder, the lay bodhisattva should give rise to three perceptions toward his own wife. What are the three? The perception of her as not his own, the perception of her as not to be possessed, and the perception of her as something borrowed.

Furthermore, householder, the lay bodhisattva should give rise to three perceptions toward his own wife. What are the three? The perception of her as a basis for bodily misconduct, the perception of her as a basis for verbal misconduct, and the perception of her as a basis for mental misconduct.

Furthermore, householder, the lay bodhisattva should give rise to three perceptions toward his own wife. What are the three? The perception of her as a basis for thoughts of desire, the perception of her as a basis for thoughts of malice, and the perception of her as a basis for thoughts of harming.

Furthermore, householder, the lay bodhisattva should give rise to three perceptions toward his own wife. What are the three? The perception of her as stocks, the perception of her as killing, and the perception of her as bondage.

Furthermore, householder, the lay bodhisattva should give rise to three perceptions toward his own wife. What are the three? The perception of her as an obstacle to moral discipline, the perception of her as an obstacle to

meditative absorption, and the perception of her as an obstacle to wisdom.

Furthermore, householder, the lay bodhisattva should give rise to three perceptions toward his own wife. What are the three? The perception of her as a trap, the perception of her as a snare, and the perception of her as a net.

Furthermore, householder, the lay bodhisattva should give rise to three perceptions toward his own wife. What are the three? The perception of her as an epidemic disease, the perception of her as harm, and the perception of her as contagion.

Furthermore, householder, the lay bodhisattva should give rise to three perceptions toward his own wife. What are the three? The perception of her as strife, the perception of her as calamity, and the perception of her as a hailstorm.

"Furthermore, householder, a householder bodhisattva should develop three perceptions toward his own wife. What are the three? The perception of her as sickness, the perception of her as old age, and the perception of her as death.

"Furthermore, householder, a householder bodhisattva should develop three perceptions toward his own wife. What are the three? The perception of her as Māra, the perception of her as a support of Māra, and the perception of her as terror.

"Furthermore, householder, a householder bodhisattva should develop three perceptions toward his own wife. What are the three? The perception of her as grief, the perception of her as lamentation, and the perception of her as suffering, unhappiness, and agitation.

"Furthermore, householder, a householder bodhisattva should develop three perceptions toward his own wife. What are the three? The perception of her as a great she-wolf, the perception of her as a great female sea monster (makara), and the perception of her as a great she-cat.

"Furthermore, householder, a householder bodhisattva should develop three perceptions toward his own wife. What are the three? The perception of her as a black she-snake, the perception of her as a child-killing sea monster, and the perception of her as a demoness who steals vitality.

"Furthermore, householder, a householder bodhisattva should develop three perceptions toward his own wife. What are the three? The perception of her as being without a protector, the perception of her as being without a refuge, and the perception of her as being without a shelter.

"Furthermore, householder, a householder bodhisattva should develop three perceptions toward his own wife. What are the three? The perception of her as fullness, the perception of her as depletion, and the perception of her as illness.

"Furthermore, householder, a householder bodhisattva should develop three perceptions toward his own wife. What are the three? The perception of her as a bandit, the perception of her as a jailer, and the perception of her as a guardian of the hells.

"Furthermore, householder, a householder bodhisattva should develop three perceptions toward his own wife. What are the three? The perception of her as a flood, the perception of her as a yoke, and the perception of her as a knot.

"Furthermore, householder, a householder bodhisattva should develop three perceptions toward his own wife. What are the three? The perception of her as a mire, the perception of her as clinging, and the perception of her as an abyss.

"Furthermore, householder, a householder bodhisattva should develop three perceptions toward his own wife. What are the three? The perception of her as a rope, the perception of her as a fetter, and the perception of her as a snare.

"Furthermore, householder, a householder bodhisattva should develop three perceptions toward his own wife. What are the three? The perception of her as hot embers, the perception of her as like a torch of burning grass, and the perception of her as like a keen blade.

"Furthermore, householder, a householder bodhisattva should develop three perceptions toward his own wife. What are the three? The perception of her as worthless, the perception of her as a thorn, and the perception of her as poison.

"Furthermore, householder, a householder bodhisattva should develop three perceptions toward his own wife. What are the three? The perception of her as excessive embellishment, the perception of her as excessively defiling, and the perception of her as excessive attachment.

"Furthermore, householder, a householder bodhisattva should develop three perceptions toward his own wife. What are the three? The perception of her as scowling, the perception of her as inflicting punishment, and the perception of her as wielding weapons.

"Furthermore, householder, a householder bodhisattva should develop three perceptions toward his own wife. What are the three? The perception of her as quarreling, the perception of her as disputing, and the perception of her as fault-finding.

"Furthermore, householder, a householder bodhisattva should develop three perceptions toward his own wife. What are the three? The perception of her as meeting with what is unpleasant, the perception of her as separation from what is dear, and the perception of her as dreadful.

"In short, he should develop the perception of her as the stain of strife, the perception of her as all the turmoil of strife, the perception of her as the cause of all harm, and the perception of her as the root of all that is unwholesome. Householder, a householder bodhisattva living in the household should examine his own wife by bringing to mind perceptions such as these.

"Furthermore, householder, a householder bodhisattva should not develop excessive affection for his son. Householder, if he does develop excessive affection for his son, and not likewise for other sentient beings, he should rebuke his own mind with three rebukes. What are the three? 'Awakening belongs to the bodhisattva whose mind is impartial, not to one whose mind is partial. Awakening belongs to the bodhisattva who applies himself correctly, not to one who applies himself wrongly. Awakening belongs to the bodhisattva who acts without making distinctions, not to one who acts making distinctions.' Having rebuked his own mind with these three rebukes, he should develop the perception of that son as unlovely.

"He should develop these three perceptions, thinking: 'This is unlovely, not something truly dear to my heart; for if, on his account, I develop excessive affection for this son, and not so for other sentient beings, I will be contravening the training taught by the Buddha. For his sake I have harmed my roots of virtue, and I have been careless even of my life and been harmed by it; so this one is someone who does me harm. Because of him I am practicing a path contrary to the path of awakening; so this one is my adversary.'

"Taking that son as the cause, he should develop his mind in this way: just as he holds thoughts of affection for that son, so he should develop loving-kindness toward all sentient beings; and just as he holds thoughts of cherishing himself, so he should develop loving-kindness.

"He should also reflect properly in this way: 'This one came from elsewhere, and I too came from elsewhere. Moreover, all sentient beings have formerly been my children, and I too have been the child of all sentient beings. Here there is no sentient being whatsoever that is mine, or another's, or anyone's.'"

Why is that? Because there is no harmony in it: in the five destinies even friends turn into enemies. Therefore I should act in such a way that I become neither a friend nor an enemy to anyone. Why is that? If one holds someone to be an enemy, one will not want to do anything at all for him. If one holds someone to be a friend, one will want to do far too much for him. With the two minds of attachment and anger, one cannot realize the equality of phenomena. Why is that? Practicing unequally leads one to go unequally, and practicing equally leads to equality. So I shall not practice unequally. If I practice equally toward all sentient beings, I shall realize omniscience.

Householder, in this way the householder bodhisattva should not grasp any thing at all as "mine," and should not be attached to it. He should not harbor the latent tendencies of guile and craving.

Householder, suppose a beggar comes to a householder bodhisattva and asks for some thing, and he does not give that thing. He should then firmly reflect in this way: "Whether I give this thing or not, I will certainly be separated from it, and I will die against my will. This thing will abandon me, and I too will abandon this thing. So I will give this thing away with a joyful mind, take its essence, and meet the time of my death. If I give it away completely, then at the time of my death my mind will not remain obsessed with it. At the time of my death this will bring me joy, supreme joy, delight, and freedom from regret."

If, even after reflecting in this way, he is unable to give the thing away, he should explain himself to the beggar with three explanations: "I am still weak, my roots of virtue have not fully matured, and I am a beginner in the Great Vehicle. I am under the sway of a mind that does not give. I still hold the view of appropriation, and I dwell in grasping at a self and grasping at what is mine. Therefore, noble one, please be patient and do not be distressed. I shall act so that your wishes and the wishes of all sentient beings are fulfilled. I shall accomplish this. I shall make the effort." In this way, householder, the householder bodhisattva should explain himself to the beggar with three explanations.

Furthermore, householder, a householder bodhisattva living at home should always and without interruption be skilled in dedication. If the scriptures of a teacher who has passed away remain, but no buddha appears, there is no teacher of the Dharma, and there is no meeting with the noble Saṅgha, he should pay homage to all the buddhas of the ten directions. He should recollect and rejoice in the complete accomplishment of all the qualities of a buddha by those who practiced in keeping with their former conduct, who practiced virtue, who were perfect in intention and in superior intention, and who attained awakening.

Moreover, three times by day and three times by night, with his bodily actions completely pure, his verbal actions completely pure, and his mental actions completely pure; being clean, pure in intention, and skilled in cultivating loving-kindness; wearing clean clothes, well adorned with a sense of shame and a sense of conscience; having gathered a stock of merit and roots of virtue; being handsome, delighting in the awakening mind, gentle, pleasant to be with, doing good deeds, respectful, and easy to speak to; and having fully cut off pride, conceit, and arrogance, he should recite the Dharma discourse of the Three Heaps (Triskandhaka): in order to confess all the faults of unwholesome actions, to restrain himself from them from now on, to rejoice in all merit, to fully complete the accumulation for the major marks, to request all the buddhas to turn the wheel of Dharma, to uphold all the teachings, and to safeguard life in the countless buddha fields.

Furthermore, householder, a householder bodhisattva living at home should take up the fasting observance with its eight branches. He should approach, rely on, and serve renunciants and brahmins who have moral discipline, who have good qualities, and who possess wholesome qualities. Approaching them, relying on them, and serving them, he should see his own faults, without error in his conduct.

Even if he sees a monk who has fallen away from the conduct of a renunciant, he should not show him even the slightest disrespect. Rather, he should give rise to this thought: "The saffron robe of the Blessed One, the Tathāgata, the arhat, the perfectly complete Buddha, who is without turbidity and free from all the turbidity of afflictions, is imbued with moral discipline, and imbued with samādhi, wisdom, liberation, and the knowledge and vision of liberation. This is the banner of the sages, the noble ones."

Having given rise to deep respect for these, he should give rise to great compassion for that monk: "This sinful conduct is not good. This afflicted conduct is not good. Although he wears the banner of the sage of the Blessed One, the Tathāgata, the arhat, the perfectly complete Buddha, who is disciplined, peaceful, restrained, and noble in bearing, he himself is not purified, not peaceful, not restrained, and not disciplined; he behaves in a way that is not noble in bearing. Since the Blessed One said, 'Do not despise those who are untrained,' this man is not at fault. The fault lies with the afflictions, with whatever afflictions display these unwholesome things. The teaching of the buddhas, the blessed ones, brings deliverance, so if he comes to understand these afflictions and examines them properly, he will attain the first fruit, and it is possible that he will become destined for unsurpassed, perfectly complete awakening."

Why is that? Because afflictions are to be cleared away by wisdom. The Blessed One (the Buddha) has also said, "A person should not take the measure of another person. If a person takes the measure of another person, he will be ruined." So, thinking, "The Tathāgata knows fully; I do not know fully," he should feel toward that monk no malice, no aversion, no resentment, and no anger.

Furthermore, householder, when that lay bodhisattva wishes to enter a monastery, he should stand at the monastery's door with a considerate mind and a pliant mind, with respect, with deference, with faith, and with reverence. He should bow to the monastery with the five limbs, and only then should he go inside. He should reflect like this: "This is the dwelling of those who dwell in emptiness. It is the dwelling of those who dwell in signlessness, in wishlessness, in loving-kindness, in compassion, in joy, and in equanimity. This is the dwelling of meditators, the dwelling of those who have completely cut off every dwelling. This is the dwelling of those who have rightly gone and of those who have rightly entered. When will I too go forth from the dusty dwelling of the household and conduct myself like this? When will I too take part in the formal acts of the Saṅgha, the act of the poṣadha, the act of the pravāraṇā, and the act of reverence?" Thinking this, he should take delight in the thought of going forth.

There has never been a bodhisattva who, while living in a household, fully awakened to unsurpassed, perfect and complete awakening. All of them went forth from the household, set their minds on the wilderness, inclined toward the wilderness, went to the wilderness, and there fully awakened to

unsurpassed, perfect and complete awakening. They also perfectly accomplished that accumulation.

Living in a household is harmful in every way; it is where dust falls. Going forth is praised by the buddhas and their śrāvakas. Living in a household is full of the stain of faults. Going forth is full of excellent qualities. Living in a household is precarious. Going forth is at ease. Living in a household is stained with possessions. Going forth is free from possessions. Living in a household is the ground of misconduct. Going forth is the ground of good conduct. Living in a household is dwelling in the midst of dust. Going forth is not dwelling in the midst of dust. Living in a household is sinking into the mire of desire. Going forth is getting out of the mire of desire. Living in a household is the way of childish people. Going forth is the way of the wise. Living in a household is a livelihood hard to purify. Going forth is a livelihood easy to purify. Living in a household has many rivals. Going forth has no rivals. Living in a household is full of want. Going forth is without want. Living in a household is a place of sorrow. Going forth is joy. Living in a household is a stairway to the lower realms. Going forth is a stairway to the higher realms. Living in a household is bondage. Going forth is liberation. Living in a household is fraught with fear. Going forth is free of fear. Living in a household is conduct that involves punishment. Going forth is conduct free of punishment. Living in a household involves the use of weapons. Going forth does not use weapons. Living in a household is full of torment. Going forth is free of torment. Living in a household is suffering because of constant seeking. Going forth is happiness because there is no seeking. Living in a household is restlessness. Going forth is peace. Living in a household is stinginess. Going forth is freedom from stinginess. Living in a household is weakness. Going forth is not weakness. Living in a household is base. Going forth is noble. Living in a household is ablaze all around. Going forth is the blaze extinguished. Living in a household is for the sake of others. Going forth is for the sake of both. Living in a household is of little benefit. Going forth is of great benefit. Living in a household has little splendor. Going forth has great splendor. Living in a household is suffering because of the afflictions. Going forth is happiness because of renunciation. Living in a household breeds thorns. Going forth removes thorns. Living in a household is endowed with lesser qualities. Going forth is endowed with great qualities. Living in a household is acting contrary to the discipline. Going forth is acting according to the discipline. Living in a household is regret. Going forth is freedom from regret. Living in a household

swells the ocean of tears, mother's milk, and blood. Going forth dries up the ocean of tears, mother's milk, and blood. Living in a household is censured by the buddhas, the pratyekabuddhas, and the śrāvakas. Going forth is praised by the buddhas, the pratyekabuddhas, and the śrāvakas. Living in a household is discontent. Going forth is contentment. Living in a household makes Māra rejoice. Going forth makes Māra grieve. Living in a household ends in great turmoil. Going forth ends in the pacification of all turmoil. Living in a household is utterly untamed. Going forth is utterly tamed. Living in a household is doing the work of a servant. Going forth is being the master. Living in a household ends in saṃsāra. Going forth ends in nirvāṇa. Living in a household is a precipice. Going forth is beyond the precipice. Living in a household is pitch darkness. Going forth is light. Living in a household is lacking mastery over the senses. Going forth is mastery over the senses. Living in a household breeds arrogance. Going forth tames arrogance. Living in a household breeds what is ignoble. Going forth breeds what is noble. Living in a household breeds the lower realms. Going forth breeds the happy destinies.

Household life is not worthy of regard; going forth is worthy of regard. Household life involves great undertakings; going forth involves few undertakings. Household life has little fruit; going forth has great fruit. Household life is crooked; going forth is straight. Household life is full of unhappiness; going forth is endowed with happiness. Household life is pierced by thorns; going forth has the thorns pulled out. Household life is sickness; going forth brings freedom from disease. Household life makes the Dharma decline; going forth makes the Dharma flourish. Household life makes one heedless; going forth makes one heedful. Household life is the source of corrupt understanding; going forth is the increase of wisdom. Household life is an obstacle to wisdom; going forth is the life-force of wisdom. Household life abides in deception; going forth abides free of deception. Household life involves many activities; going forth involves few activities. Household life is like a drink mixed with poison; going forth is like a drink mixed with nectar. Household life is harmful; going forth is harmless. Household life is entangled; going forth is unentangled. Household life is like the kimpaka fruit; going forth is like the fruit of nectar. Household life brings one together with what is unpleasant; going forth parts one from what is unpleasant. Household life parts one from what is dear; going forth brings one together with what is dear. Household life is heavy with delusion; going forth is light with wisdom. Household life ruins one's practice; going forth purifies one's practice.

Household life ruins one's intention; going forth purifies one's intention. Household life ruins one's superior intention; going forth purifies one's superior intention.

Household life leaves one without an ally; going forth provides an ally. Household life leaves one without a protector; going forth provides a protector. Household life leaves one without a shelter; going forth provides a shelter. Household life leaves one without a refuge; going forth provides a refuge. Household life is full of malice; going forth is full of loving-kindness. Household life is carrying a burden; going forth is having laid the burden down. Household life is activity without end; going forth brings all activity to its end. Household life is blameworthy; going forth is blameless. Household life leads to torment; going forth does not lead to torment. Household life is accompanied by afflictions; going forth is free of afflictions. Household life is bound up with material things; going forth is free of material things. Household life is accompanied by conceit; going forth is free of conceit. Household life takes wealth as its essence; going forth takes good qualities as its essence. Household life is an epidemic; going forth quells the epidemic. Household life is decline; going forth is increase. Household life is easy to find; going forth is hard to find even in a hundred thousand eons. Household life is easy to undertake; going forth is hard to undertake. Household life goes with the current; going forth goes against the current.

Household life is a flood; going forth is a boat. Household life is the flood of afflictions; going forth is a bridge. Household life is the near shore; going forth is the far shore. Household life offers an opening; going forth offers no opening. Household life is full of vexation; going forth is vexation stilled. Household life follows the decrees of the king; going forth follows the teaching of the Buddha. Household life is wretched; going forth is free of wretchedness. Household life is the source of suffering; going forth is the source of happiness. Household life is shallow; going forth is profound. In household life companions are plentiful; in going forth companions are rare. Household life is keeping company with a wife; going forth is keeping company with faith. Household life is like a net; going forth is the net torn apart. Household life prizes harming others; going forth prizes benefiting others. Household life holds the gift of material things in high esteem; going forth holds the gift of the Dharma in high esteem. Household life raises the banner of Māra; going forth raises the banner of the Buddha. Household life is the ground of suffering; going forth utterly destroys the ground of suffering. Household life makes the aggregates

increase; going forth definitively casts off all the aggregates. Household life is a dense thicket; going forth is liberation from the thicket.

Thus, householder, a lay bodhisattva should be intent on going forth. He should also give rise to this thought: "Even if for many days I were to make offerings as numerous as the sands of the river Ganges, and were to give away all my possessions entirely, all of that would be surpassed by the mind that resolves to go forth in the well-taught Dharma and Vinaya." Why is that? Householder, even the faithless, the ungrateful, thieves, caṇḍālas, the king's retainers, and ministers give gifts; the gift of material things is inferior.

Householder, the lay bodhisattva should give rise to this thought: "I shall not be content with giving alone as my essence. I shall also make moral discipline, learning, and pure conduct my essence."

When he comes to a monastery, he should pay homage to the emblems of the Tathāgata. Having paid homage to them, he should give rise to three perceptions. What are the three? "May I too become worthy of offerings like this." "Out of compassion for sentient beings, I too shall consecrate my own body." And, "Just as the Tathāgata fully awakened to unsurpassed, perfect and complete awakening, performed the deeds of a buddha, and passed into complete nirvāṇa, so I too shall quickly awaken, perform the deeds of a buddha, and pass into complete nirvāṇa. In this way I shall train, and in this way I shall strive."

When he enters the monastery, he should carefully examine all the conduct of the Saṅgha of monks, asking: "Which monk is learned? Which monk is a preacher of the Dharma? Which monk upholds the Vinaya? Which monk upholds the Mātṛkā? Which monk upholds the Bodhisattva Piṭaka? Which monk is a forest dweller? Which lives on alms? Which wears robes of rags, has few desires, is content, and lives in seclusion? Which monk practices yoga? Which monk is a meditator? Which monk belongs to the Bodhisattva Vehicle? Which monk is the superintendent of works? Which monk performs services? Which monk acts as steward?"

Having examined their conduct, he should live in harmony with each of them as is fitting, so as to be in accord with them all. He should not display one kind of conduct before some and another kind before others. Why is that? In the monastery there are the village's secrets, and in the village there are the monastery's secrets. Keeping his speech well restrained, he should not recount the monastery's secrets in the village, nor the village's secrets in the

monastery.

Whatever monk lacks robes, or lacks a bowl, or lacks medicine for illness and other requisites, he should give to him in such a way that others do not revile him or become angry. Why is that? Because jealousy and avarice are the fetters of gods and humans. Therefore he should be carefully on guard with ordinary beings, but not with arhats. Why is that? Because faults arise from ordinary beings, not from arhats.

Therefore, relying on the learned, he should strive to seek out learning. Relying on the preachers of the Dharma, he should strive in discourse that brings certainty. Relying on those who uphold the Vinaya, he should strive to tame his offenses and to tame his afflictions. Relying on those who uphold the Mātṛkā, he should strive in the restraint of body, speech, and mind. Relying on those who uphold the Bodhisattva Piṭaka, he should strive in the six perfections and in skill in means. Relying on the forest dwellers, he should strive in seclusion. Relying on those who live on alms, he should strive to remain unshaken by gain and loss, fame and obscurity, praise and blame, pleasure and suffering. Relying on those who wear robes of rags, he should strive to be satisfied with robes and to take no delight in ornaments. Relying on those of few desires, he should strive to have few desires. Relying on the contented, he should strive to be content. Relying on those who live in seclusion, he should strive in seclusion. Relying on those who practice yoga, he should strive to settle the mind inwardly in calm abiding and insight, with proper attention. Relying on the meditators, he should strive to remove the afflictions. Relying on those of the Bodhisattva Vehicle, he should strive in the four means of attracting disciples: giving, pleasant speech, beneficial conduct, and consistency of aim. Relying on the superintendent of works, he should strive to take delight in giving things away as is fitting. Relying on those who perform services, he should strive to do whatever needs to be done. Relying on those who act as stewards, he should not let his mind grow weary.

Householder, in this way the lay bodhisattva living at home should strive to follow their conduct just as it is.

When he wins over with robes or with a bowl a monk who has not yet entered the genuine, flawless state, he should cause that monk to take up unsurpassed, perfect and complete awakening. Why is that? Because there is the possibility that gathering him with material things will give rise to gathering him through the Dharma.

Householder, in this way the lay bodhisattva should become skilled in the conduct of renunciants. He should also reconcile monks who are at odds. When the true Dharma is being utterly destroyed, he should give up even his life and uphold the true Dharma.

Householder, if a lay bodhisattva sees a sick monk, he should cure that monk of his illness even with his own flesh and blood.

Furthermore, householder, the lay bodhisattva, generous and giving, should look after others as his guests, and having given, he does not give rise to regret. He should let the awakening mind go before all his roots of virtue.

Householder, in this way the lay bodhisattva who abides in the householder's state carries out the command of the Tathāgatas. He does not decline, he does not in any way decline, from the factors conducive to awakening. In this life he has no blameworthy deeds, and elsewhere too he will go to a distinguished state.

Then the householder Ugra and those other householders, with one voice, praised what the Blessed One had said and spoke to the Blessed One: "It is wondrous how well the Blessed One has explained these faults of living at home, the vows, the conduct, and the benefits of the qualities of going forth!"

"Blessed One, we too have now seen directly, here and now, how many faults and defects cling to the household life, and how boundless are the qualities and benefits of going forth. Blessed One, please let us go forth, and grant us full ordination in the Dharma and Vinaya so well taught by the Sugata."

When they had made this request, the Blessed One said to those householders, "Householders, going forth is hard to achieve, and it is very hard to make one's conduct completely pure."

When he had said this, those householders said to the Blessed One, "Blessed One, going forth is indeed hard to achieve. Even so, may the Blessed One please give us the opportunity to go forth. We wish to practice the Blessed One's teaching with dedication."

The Blessed One gave those householders the opportunity to go forth. Then the Blessed One spoke to the bodhisattva Maitreya and the bodhisattva Completely Pure in All Conduct: "Noble men, the two of you, give these householders the going forth and full ordination."

With the Blessed One's permission, the bodhisattva Maitreya gave the going forth to nine thousand householders, and the bodhisattva Completely Pure in

All Conduct gave the going forth to seven thousand householders.

When this Dharma discourse, which teaches the continuous training of lay bodhisattvas, had been explained, a full thousand living beings set their minds on unsurpassed, perfect, complete awakening.

The third and final fascicle.

Then the householder Ugra said to the Blessed One, "Blessed One, the Blessed One has explained the faults of the household and of household life for lay bodhisattvas. Now may the Blessed One please explain well, for bodhisattvas who belong among those gone forth, the practice of one who has gone forth, together with moral discipline, learning, the qualities of ascetic purification, having few possessions, conduct, and perfection in proper observance. Blessed One, how does a bodhisattva who has gone forth in the well-taught Dharma and Vinaya ensure that the respectful words, prostrations, rising to greet him, joined palms and acts of homage offered to him are not without purpose?"

When he had asked this, the Blessed One said to the householder Ugra, "Householder, it is excellent, excellent, that you ask the Tathāgata about all this: the practice of one who has gone forth, moral discipline, learning, the qualities of ascetic purification, having few possessions, conduct, and perfection in proper observance. Therefore, householder, listen well and carefully and keep it in mind, and I shall explain to you how a bodhisattva who belongs among those gone forth should live and how he should practice."

"Excellent, Blessed One," replied the householder Ugra, and he listened as the Blessed One had told him. The Blessed One then said to him:

"Householder, a bodhisattva who has gone forth should reflect, 'For whose sake have I gone forth from home into homelessness?' Seeking wisdom, he should exert himself with diligence, as if his head and clothes were on fire. Reflecting in this way, from the very outset he should be firmly established in the four lineages of the noble ones, and he should delight in the qualities of ascetic purification and in having few possessions.

"Householder, if one asks how a bodhisattva who has gone forth is firmly established in the four lineages of the noble ones: householder, a bodhisattva who has gone forth is content with any poor robe, and he also speaks in praise of contentment with poor robes. He does not seek robes by improper means. If he does not obtain a robe, he is not dejected and feels no distress. If he does

obtain one, he has no attachment, no infatuation, no delight in it, no clinging, and he does not come to cling to it. Seeing its drawbacks and knowing well the way of release, he uses it without attachment. Content with poor robes, he does not praise himself and does not disparage others.

"Furthermore, householder, a bodhisattva who has gone forth is content with any poor almsfood, and he also speaks in praise of contentment with poor almsfood. He does not seek almsfood by improper means. If he does not obtain almsfood, he is not dejected and feels no distress. If he does obtain it, he has no attachment, no infatuation, no delight in it, no clinging, and he does not come to cling to it. Seeing its drawbacks and knowing well the way of release, he uses it without attachment. Content with poor almsfood, he does not praise himself and does not disparage others.

"Furthermore, householder, a bodhisattva who has gone forth is content with any poor bedding and seat, and he also speaks in praise of contentment with poor bedding and seats. He does not seek bedding and seats by improper means. If he does not obtain them, he is not dejected and feels no distress. If he does obtain them, he has no attachment, no infatuation, no delight in them, no clinging, and he does not come to cling to them. Seeing their drawbacks and knowing well the way of release, he uses them without attachment. Content with poor bedding and seats, he does not praise himself and does not disparage others.

"Furthermore, householder, a bodhisattva who has gone forth is content with any poor medicine and requisites for the sick, and he also speaks in praise of contentment with poor medicine and requisites for the sick. He does not seek medicine and requisites for the sick by improper means. If he does not obtain them, he is not dejected and feels no distress. If he does obtain them, he has no attachment, no infatuation, no delight in them, no clinging, and he does not come to cling to them. Seeing their drawbacks and knowing well the way of release, he uses them without attachment. Content with poor medicine and requisites for the sick, he does not praise himself and does not disparage others."

He also delights in abandoning. He is devoted to abandoning and strives in the practice of delighting in abandoning. He becomes joyful by having abandoned evil and nonvirtuous phenomena, not by leaving them unabandoned. He delights in cultivation and strives in the practice of delighting in cultivation. He becomes joyful by having cultivated virtuous phenomena, not by leaving them

uncultivated. Though he delights in abandoning, is devoted to abandoning, and strives in the practice of delighting in abandoning, and though he delights in cultivation, is devoted to cultivation, and strives in the practice of delighting in cultivation, he does not praise himself or disparage others. Householder, in this way the renunciant bodhisattva abides in the four noble lineages. Why are they called the noble lineages? Because all the factors conducive to awakening abide in them, they are called the noble lineages.

Further, householder, the renunciant bodhisattva should wear the Dharma robes on his body, delighting in their benefits for ten reasons. What are the ten? They are these. He wears them to cover himself, out of shame and modesty. He wears them as a covering against being touched by gadflies, mosquitoes, wind, sun, and snakes. He wears them to display the color and the sign of a renunciant. Thinking, "These saffron robes are a shrine for the world with its gods, humans, and asuras," he takes them up properly for the sake of that shrine. He wears them thinking, "These are dyed in their color through disenchantment and freedom from desire; they are not dyed in their color by desire." He wears them thinking, "These accord with peace; they do not accord with the blaze of the afflictions." Wrapped and covered in these saffron robes, he turns back from evil. He wears them to do good deeds. He does not strive to adorn himself with the robes. And knowing that these saffron robes accord with the accumulations of the noble path, he should wear the saffron robes so as not to keep company with defilement for even a single instant. Householder, the renunciant bodhisattva should wear the Dharma robes on his body, delighting in their benefits for these ten reasons.

Further, householder, having seen ten benefits, the renunciant bodhisattva should not give up the practice of the alms round for as long as he lives. What are the ten? He reflects: "I should live by a way of life that is independent, not by depending on others. Those beings who give alms to me when I seek alms I should first establish in the Three Jewels, and only afterward accept their alms. For those beings who do not give alms to me when I seek alms, I should generate great compassion, and I should apply diligence in order to bring those beings to generosity. I eat the alms having done what is to be done. I will have acted in accordance with the command of the Tathāgata. I will create the cause for being easy to satisfy and easy to support. I will display the overcoming of pride. I will accumulate roots of virtue whose crown of the head cannot be seen. Seeing me, others will train in the same way, and I will not become intimate with men, women, boys, or girls. And because I hold an even

mind toward all sentient beings, the practice of properly receiving alms will become an accumulation for the wisdom of omniscience." Householder, having seen these ten benefits, the renunciant bodhisattva should not give up the practice of the alms round until the end of his life.

If someone invites him as a guest, he should go in order to generate superior intention, faith, and clear confidence, not through deceit or hypocrisy. If someone, having received alms, is able to accomplish the aims of both self and others, I permit that bodhisattva to go as a guest.

Further, householder, having seen ten benefits, the renunciant bodhisattva should be content with putrid medicine for as long as he lives. What are the ten? He reflects: "I will have entered the teaching of the Tathāgata. I will not look to the faces of others. I will rely on the perception of the unattractive. The perception of the repulsive will be present to me in each case. With little trouble I will abandon attachment to fine flavors. All childish ordinary beings will place their trust in me. My restraint in food will become evident. I will suffer no hardship in seeking medicine. I will have freed the mind from the harm of the disease of afflictions. And entering in this way, I will quickly attain freedom from the disease of afflictions." Householder, having seen these ten benefits, the renunciant bodhisattva should be content with putrid medicine for as long as he lives.

Further, householder, having seen ten benefits, the renunciant bodhisattva should never give up dwelling in the wilderness until the end of his life. What are the ten? He is at ease, and goes under his own control. He is without the sense of "mine" and without possessiveness. He gives up bedding freely. He is never parted from delight in the wilderness dwelling. In dwellings he has few concerns and few activities. He abandons the crowd of attendants and has no regard for body or life. He delights in solitude and completely abandons bustle. He completely gives up the benefits of the merits of work performed. His mind is one-pointed, in accord with meditative absorption. And his attention is unconcealed, his attention free of obscuration. Householder, having seen these ten benefits, the renunciant bodhisattva should never give up dwelling in the wilderness until the end of his life.

Householder, if a bodhisattva who dwells in the wilderness comes to a village dwelling because he wishes to hear the Dharma, or wishes to see his teacher or preceptor, or to inquire after the sick, he should go with the intention of returning by evening. And if he depends on others for receiving scriptural

transmission and for recitation, and so lives in a monastery, he too, with a mind inclined toward the wilderness, should think: "To perceive all things as wilderness, and to be insatiable in seeking the Dharma, that itself is dwelling in the wilderness."

Furthermore, householder, a bodhisattva who has gone forth and dwells in the wilderness should reflect in this way: "Why do I dwell in the wilderness? Merely dwelling in the wilderness does not make one a renunciant (śramaṇa). Many who are untrained, unguarded, unpacified, undisciplined, without energy and without diligence also dwell here: deer, monkeys, a great many birds, robbers, and outcastes (caṇḍālas). Yet they do not possess the qualities of a renunciant. Therefore I dwell in the wilderness so that I may completely fulfill the aim of a renunciant."

Householder, what is the aim of a renunciant for a bodhisattva who has gone forth? It is this: mindfulness, vigilance, freedom from distraction, the full attainment of the dhāraṇīs, the cultivation of loving-kindness, the cultivation of compassion, mastery of the higher knowledges, bringing to completion the practice of the six perfections, never abandoning the mind set on omniscience, the cultivation of the wisdom of skillful means, gathering beings, bringing beings to maturity, never abandoning the four means of gathering, recollecting the six recollections, learning, never giving up diligence, discerning the Dharma correctly, striving for perfect liberation, knowing the fruits that are attained, abiding in the entry into faultlessness, and guarding the true Dharma.

It is right view, through confidence in the maturation of karma; right thought, through having cut off all thought and conceptualization; right speech, through teaching the Dharma in accordance with others' inclinations; right action, through bringing the exhaustion of karma to completion; right livelihood, through having thoroughly destroyed the rebirth-linking of habitual tendencies; right effort, through realizing perfect awakening; right mindfulness, through the nature of non-forgetting; and right concentration, through fully attaining the wisdom of omniscience.

It is not being frightened by emptiness, not being discouraged by signlessness, not being daunted by wishlessness, and deliberately taking up existence through wisdom. It is relying on the meaning and not relying on the letter; relying on wisdom and not relying on consciousness; relying on the Dharma and not relying on the person; relying on the sūtras of definitive meaning and

not relying on the sūtras of provisional meaning. And it is not conceptualizing the essential nature of phenomena, in the manner of their being from the very beginning unarisen and unceasing. Householder, this is called the aim of a renunciant for a bodhisattva who has gone forth.

Again, householder, a bodhisattva who has gone forth should for the most part remain without companionship. He should reflect in this way: "I should not mingle with beings. I am not to generate the roots of virtue of just one being; I am to generate the roots of virtue of all beings."

Nevertheless, householder, the Tathāgata has permitted these four kinds of association for a bodhisattva who has gone forth. What are the four? Association for the sake of hearing the Dharma, association for the sake of bringing beings to maturity, association for the sake of making offerings and service to the Tathāgata, and association that keeps the mind set on omniscience unadulterated. Householder, these four kinds of association for a bodhisattva who has gone forth have been permitted by the Tathāgata. Therefore, householder, a bodhisattva who has gone forth should be free of association.

Furthermore, householder, a bodhisattva who has gone forth and dwells in the wilderness should reflect, "Why have I come to the wilderness?" And he should think thus: "I have come to the wilderness because I am afraid and terrified. Of what am I afraid and terrified?

I am afraid and terrified of bustle.
I am afraid and terrified of companionship.
I am afraid and terrified of attachment, aversion and delusion.
I am afraid and terrified of pride, arrogance and concealment.
I am afraid and terrified of craving, envy and stinginess.
I am afraid and terrified of forms, sounds, smells, tastes and tangible objects.
I am afraid and terrified of the māra of the aggregates.
I am afraid and terrified of the māra of the afflictions.
I am afraid and terrified of the māra of the Lord of Death.
I am afraid and terrified of the māra who is a son of the gods.
I am afraid and terrified of the inversion of taking the impermanent as permanent.
I am afraid and terrified of the inversion of taking suffering as happiness.
I am afraid and terrified of the inversion of taking what is without self as a self.
I am afraid and terrified of the inversion of taking the impure as pure.

I am afraid and terrified of mind, mentation and consciousness.
I am afraid and terrified of craving.
I am afraid and terrified of saṃsāra.
I am afraid and terrified of obscurations, hindrances and outbursts of affliction.
I am afraid and terrified of the view of the transitory collection.
I am afraid and terrified of grasping at "I" and grasping at "mine".
I am afraid and terrified of agitation.
I am afraid and terrified of regret and doubt.
I am afraid and terrified of evil companions.
I am afraid and terrified of gain and honor.
I am afraid and terrified of non-virtuous spiritual friends.
I am afraid and terrified of thinking I have seen what I have not seen.
I am afraid and terrified of thinking I have heard what I have not heard.
I am afraid and terrified of thinking I remember what I do not remember.
I am afraid and terrified of thinking I have discerned what I have not discerned.
I am afraid and terrified of thinking I know what I do not know.
I am afraid and terrified of the stains of a renunciant.
I am afraid and terrified of intending harm toward one another.
I am afraid and terrified of the desire realm, the form realm and the formless realm.
I am afraid and terrified of death, transmigration and birth in all the destinies of existence.
I am afraid and terrified of going to the hells, to birth as an animal, and to the realm of the hungry ghosts.
I am afraid and terrified of the states without leisure.

In short, he is afraid and terrified of attending to any unwholesome phenomena. He should reflect carefully: "Afraid and terrified of such things, frightened by those fears, I have come to the wilderness. One who lives in a household, lives amid busyness, is not diligent and does not apply himself to yoga, and lives with improper attention cannot be completely freed from such fears and terrors. All the bodhisattva great beings who arose in the past also dwelt in the wilderness and were liberated from all fears; that is, they attained unsurpassed, perfect awakening, which is free of fear. All the bodhisattva great beings who will arise in the future will also dwell in the wilderness and be liberated from all fears; that is, they will attain unsurpassed, perfect awakening, which is free of fear. All the bodhisattva great beings of the

present time who attain unsurpassed, perfect awakening also dwell in the wilderness and are liberated from all fears; that is, they attain unsurpassed, perfect awakening, which is free of fear. Therefore I too am afraid and terrified of this. Because I wish to pass completely beyond all fears and wish to attain fearlessness, I shall dwell in the wilderness."

Furthermore, householder, a bodhisattva who has gone forth dwells in a wilderness abode out of fear and terror. He should train himself to think: "Whatever slight fear arises in me here, all of it arises from grasping at a self. It arises from clinging to a self, from thoroughly grasping at a self, from the basis of a self, from craving for a self, from perceiving a self, from appropriating the doctrine of a self, from the view of a self, from the abode of a self, from conceptualizing a self, and from guarding a self. If I dwell in the wilderness but have not abandoned grasping at a self, if I have not abandoned clinging to a self, thoroughly grasping at a self, the basis of a self, craving for a self, perceiving a self, appropriating the doctrine of a self, the view of a self, the abode of a self, conceptualizing a self, and guarding a self, then my dwelling in the wilderness will be pointless."

For one who perceives a self there is no dwelling in the wilderness. Nor is there for one who perceives another. For one attached to grasping at "I" and grasping at "mine" there is no dwelling in the wilderness. For one whose view is objectifying there is no dwelling in the wilderness. For one with inverted views there is no dwelling in the wilderness. Householder, if even one who perceives nirvāṇa has no dwelling in the wilderness, what need is there to mention one who holds perceptions of all the afflictions?

Householder, "dwelling in the wilderness" means dwelling without relying on any phenomenon. It is dwelling without grasping any phenomenon. It is dwelling without attachment to any sign. It is dwelling without relying on any form. It is dwelling without relying on any sound, smell, taste, or tangible object. It is dwelling without conflict with the sameness of all phenomena. It is dwelling thoroughly tamed, because the mind is thoroughly at peace. It is dwelling without fear, because all fears have been abandoned. It is dwelling having crossed the flood, because one is liberated from all afflictions. It is dwelling steadfast. It is dwelling in delight in the lineages of the noble ones, being content with whatever is poor and having few desires. It is dwelling satisfied, being easy to fill and easy to support. It is dwelling in learning, applying oneself properly for the sake of wisdom. It is dwelling in liberation, discerning the gates of liberation: emptiness, signlessness, and wishlessness.

It is dwelling in freedom, having cut the bonds. It is dwelling in the pacification of what is untamed, in accordance with dependent origination. It is dwelling having done what was to be done, being thoroughly purified.

Householder, consider this example: grass, trees, and forests stand in the wilderness, yet they have no fear and do not become terrified. In the same way, householder, a bodhisattva who has gone forth and dwells in the wilderness should generate the perception that his body is like grass, trees, medicinal plants, walls, wood, a mirage, and an illusion, and should generate the thought: "Who here could become afraid? Who here could become terrified?"

When he looks at that fear and terror, he should properly examine the body, thinking: "In this body there is no self, no sentient being, no life-force, no one who is born, no nourisher, no man, no person, no one born of Manu, no child of Manu. So this thing called fear is an unreal imputation, and I shall not conceptualize that unreal imputation."

Just as grass, trees, medicinal plants, and forests in the wilderness have no sense of "mine" and no possessiveness, so the bodhisattva too, having no sense of "mine" and no possessiveness, should understand that all phenomena are wilderness, and should dwell in that practice. Why is this? Dwelling in the wilderness cuts off the afflictions; it is without "mine" and without possessiveness.

Furthermore, householder, for a bodhisattva who has gone forth and dwells in the wilderness, dwelling in the wilderness here is in harmony with the aggregate of moral discipline. Dwelling in the wilderness inclines toward the aggregate of meditative absorption. Dwelling in the wilderness gathers the aggregate of wisdom. Dwelling in the wilderness accomplishes the aggregate of liberation. Dwelling in the wilderness gives rise to the aggregate of the knowledge and vision of liberation. Dwelling in the wilderness is thorough cultivation of the factors of awakening. Dwelling in the wilderness gathers the twelve qualities of ascetic purification (dhutaguṇas). Dwelling in the wilderness is realization of the truths. Dwelling in the wilderness is full understanding of the aggregates. Dwelling in the wilderness is measuring the elements as equal to the dharmadhātu. Dwelling in the wilderness dispels the sense sources. Dwelling in the wilderness is not forgetting the awakening mind. Dwelling in the wilderness is freedom from terror through discerning emptiness. Dwelling in the wilderness is upholding the Dharma.

Dwelling in the wilderness does not let any root of virtue go to waste. Dwelling in the wilderness is praised by the buddhas. Dwelling in the wilderness is extolled by the bodhisattvas. Dwelling in the wilderness is honored by the noble ones. Dwelling in the wilderness is frequented by those who seek liberation. Dwelling in the wilderness is to be relied upon in order to realize the wisdom of omniscience. Thus one should train.

Furthermore, householder, a bodhisattva who has gone forth and dwells in the wilderness completes the cultivation of the six perfections with little difficulty. Why is that? A bodhisattva who dwells in the wilderness has no regard even for body and life. In this way, for one who dwells in the wilderness, the cultivation of the perfection of generosity becomes complete.

Householder, how does the cultivation of the perfection of moral discipline become complete for a bodhisattva who has gone forth and dwells in the wilderness? Householder, a bodhisattva who has gone forth and dwells in the wilderness is firmly established in the ascetic qualities and in having few requisites, and he correctly accomplishes the three restraints. In this way, for one who dwells in the wilderness, the cultivation of the perfection of moral discipline becomes complete.

Householder, how does the cultivation of the perfection of patience become complete for a bodhisattva who has gone forth and dwells in the wilderness? Householder, a bodhisattva who has gone forth and dwells in the wilderness has no malice in his mind and shows loving-kindness toward all sentient beings. He has acceptance even toward omniscience itself. In this way, for one who dwells in the wilderness, the cultivation of the perfection of patience becomes complete.

Householder, how does the cultivation of the perfection of diligence become complete for a bodhisattva who has gone forth and dwells in the wilderness? Householder, here a bodhisattva who has gone forth trains, thinking, "Until I attain acceptance of nonarising, I shall not turn back from this wilderness." In this way, for one who dwells in the wilderness, the full cultivation of the perfection of diligence becomes complete.

Householder, how does the cultivation of the perfection of meditative concentration become complete for a bodhisattva who has gone forth and dwells in the wilderness? Householder, a bodhisattva who has gone forth and dwells in the wilderness attains the perfection of meditative concentration. He does not neglect bringing sentient beings to maturity, and in this way he also

wishes to accumulate roots of virtue. In this way, for one who dwells in the wilderness, the cultivation of the perfection of meditative concentration becomes complete.

Householder, how does the cultivation of the Perfection of Wisdom become complete for a bodhisattva who has gone forth and dwells in the wilderness? Householder, here a bodhisattva who has gone forth trains, thinking, "As the body is, so too is the wilderness. As the body is, so too is awakening." Through suchness he does not conceptualize and does not discriminate. In this way, for one who dwells in the wilderness, the cultivation of the Perfection of Wisdom becomes complete.

Householder, it is thus that a bodhisattva who has gone forth and dwells in the wilderness completes the cultivation of the six perfections with little difficulty.

Householder, a bodhisattva who has gone forth is permitted to dwell in the wilderness if he possesses four qualities. What are the four? Householder, here a bodhisattva who has gone forth is learned: he retains what he has heard, is skilled in ascertaining the Dharma, strives in proper attention, and practices the Dharma and what accords with the Dharma. Such a one should dwell in the wilderness.

Furthermore, householder, if a bodhisattva who has gone forth has a strong share of afflictions, then, in order to pacify the afflictions, he should dwell in the wilderness without companions; he should subdue the afflictions.

Furthermore, householder, a bodhisattva who has gone forth has attained the five superknowledges. He should dwell in the wilderness in order to bring to maturity the gods, nāgas, yakṣas, and gandharvas.

Furthermore, householder, a bodhisattva who has gone forth, knowing that the Buddha has declared the wilderness permitted, should dwell in the wilderness, for there all wholesome qualities become complete. Once he has become firmly established through his roots of virtue, he should go back into the villages, towns, market towns, districts, provinces, and royal capitals and teach the Dharma.

Householder, if a bodhisattva who has gone forth possesses these four qualities, he is permitted to dwell in the wilderness.

Householder, if a bodhisattva who has gone forth enters the community in order to receive scriptural transmission and recitation, he should conduct himself there with respect. He should be courteous toward the teachers and

preceptors, the elders, those of middle standing, and the newly ordained monks. He should be skillful in his conduct. He should do his own tasks without laziness and without troubling others. He should not be eager to receive service. He should reflect, "If even the Tathāgata, the arhat, the perfectly complete Buddha, who is honored by the world with its gods, māras, and Brahmās, by the race of ascetics and brahmins, and by gods, humans, and asuras, and who is worthy of offerings, does not claim service from any sentient being whatsoever, what need is there to speak of us who are untrained and wish to train? I shall serve all sentient beings, but I shall not claim service from anyone."

Why is that? Householder, a monk who is eager to receive service wastes the good qualities he has taken up. Those whom he gathers around him also think, "We are gathered for the sake of service, not for the sake of the Dharma," and so he wastes his own faith. And for those who serve him with worldly material goods, it will not be of great benefit, nor will it bear great fruit.

When he goes to see his teacher and his preceptor, he should go with body and mind made workable and with his mind alert, thinking, "Should the teacher and preceptor discern in me any trace of faithlessness, they might not help me with oral transmission, recitation practice, and instruction." For the sake of receiving oral transmission and practicing recitation, he should disregard even his body and his life. Wishing for the Dharma, he should fully satisfy the intentions of his teachers and preceptors. Seeking good qualities, he should not seek gain, honor, or fame of any kind.

Householder, suppose a bodhisattva who seeks oral transmission and recitation hears, receives, or retains from someone else even a single four-line verse. It may be a four-line verse concerning generosity, moral discipline, patience, diligence, meditative concentration, and wisdom, or one concerning the accumulations of the bodhisattva path. Whoever he heard it from, he should honor that teacher for the sake of the Dharma. Count the names, words, and syllables with which that verse was taught. For that many eons he might attend upon that teacher without guile, serve him, and make offerings to him with every kind of gain and honor. Even then, householder, he would still not have completed the respect owed to the teacher as his teacher. How much less, then, would he complete it with respect that is not in keeping with the Dharma!

Householder, he listens with faith, meditates, and takes up recitation. Count every movement of his mind and mental factors that is joined with virtue, or with the Buddha, or with the Dharma, or with the Saṅgha, or with disenchantment and freedom from desire, or with purity, discipline, and peace. For that many eons he might serve the teacher. Even then, householder, he would still not have completed the respect owed to the teacher as his teacher.

Householder, from this account as well one should understand that the qualities of ripening are immeasurable and the realization of wisdom is immeasurable. Therefore, householder, the bodhisattva should think, "Since I have asked about the immeasurable qualities of ripening and the immeasurable realization of wisdom, my teacher too is immeasurable." He should then show immeasurable respect for the Dharma.

Furthermore, householder, a bodhisattva who has gone forth should abide in the practice of one who has gone forth. Householder, how does a bodhisattva who has gone forth abide in the practice of one who has gone forth? Householder, when a bodhisattva who has gone forth hears of pure moral discipline, he trains in it.

These four are pure moral discipline. What are the four? Abiding in the lineages of the noble ones; delighting in the qualities of ascetic practice and in having few possessions; not mixing with those who live in households or with those who have gone forth; and dwelling in the wilderness without hypocrisy. These four are pure moral discipline.

Householder, there are four further kinds of pure moral discipline. What are the four? Restraining the body, and so not apprehending a body; restraining speech, and so not apprehending speech; restraining the mind, and so not apprehending a mind; and, being free of views, setting the mind on omniscience. These four are pure moral discipline.

Householder, there are four further kinds of pure moral discipline. What are the four? Abandoning the grasping at "I"; casting off the grasping at "mine"; being free of annihilation and permanence; and entering into the dharma of dependent origination. These four are pure moral discipline.

Householder, there are four further kinds of pure moral discipline. What are the four? Examining the aggregates as arising and perishing; measuring the elements fully as the dharmadhātu; perceiving the sense sources as an empty village; and not clinging to conventional designations. These four are pure moral discipline.

Householder, there are four further kinds of pure moral discipline. What are the four? Perceiving the self as selfless, and so not praising oneself; not apprehending others, and so not disparaging others; having a thoroughly trained mind, and so being without conceit; and being unwavering because all phenomena are equal. These four are pure moral discipline.

Householder, there are four further kinds of pure moral discipline. What are the four? Devotion to emptiness; having no fear of signlessness; great compassion for all sentient beings; and acceptance of selflessness. These four are pure moral discipline.

Furthermore, householder, when a bodhisattva who has gone forth hears of pure meditative absorption, he trains in it. What is pure meditative absorption? It is being without striving toward any phenomenon. It is being nondual and undivided, since all phenomena are equal. The mind is workable, one-pointed, and definitively freed. The mind does not scatter, does not run about, and does not settle anywhere. The mind is firmly resolved on definite reflection. It is mastery over the mind. The mind is unattached to the qualities of the senses, and it examines phenomena as illusions. Just as the dharmadhātu is unconditioned, and just as it is unborn, unarisen, and equal, so, householder, does a bodhisattva who has gone forth examine pure meditative absorption.

Furthermore, householder, when a bodhisattva who has gone forth hears of the pure perfection of wisdom, he trains in it. What is that pure wisdom? He examines it in this way: it is knowing all phenomena directly, knowing the distinctions of words, knowing how to apply the analytical knowledges (pratisaṃvid), and knowing how to make other sentient beings understand the Dharma. In this way, householder, a bodhisattva who has gone forth examines pure wisdom.

Furthermore, householder, a bodhisattva who has gone forth trains thoroughly in this, thinking: "This wisdom, being bodiless, has the characteristic of being unobstructed. Being without movement, it has the characteristic of being ungraspable. Being unborn, it has the characteristic of not abiding. Being like space, without essential nature, it has the characteristic of being unconditioned."

"Householder, this examination of phenomena in this way is the practice of a bodhisattva who has gone forth."

When the Blessed One (the Buddha) taught this Dharma discourse, a hundred thousand living beings set their minds on unsurpassed, perfect and complete awakening. Of all those householders, most attained acceptance of the nonarising of phenomena. In thirty-two thousand living beings, the Dharma eye regarding phenomena became free of dust, stainless and pure.

Then the householder Ugra was delighted and glad. Overjoyed, filled with satisfaction and happiness, he placed upon the body of the Blessed One a pair of fine cotton cloths worth a hundred thousand, and said this: "Blessed One, I dedicate this root of virtue of mine to sentient beings. Through this root of virtue of mine, may the qualities of all who are householder bodhisattvas be brought to perfection, just as the training of householder bodhisattvas has been laid down. And just as the Blessed One has laid down the training of bodhisattvas who have gone forth, so may the qualities of all who are bodhisattvas gone forth be brought to perfection.

"I also wish to ask the Blessed One something. Blessed One, possessing how many qualities does a householder bodhisattva who lives at home train in the training of one who has gone forth?"

When he had asked this, the Blessed One said to the householder Ugra: "Householder, a householder bodhisattva who lives at home trains in the training of one who has gone forth if he possesses five qualities. What are the five?

"Householder, a householder bodhisattva who lives at home gives away all things completely, without regard for them, and, being endowed with the wisdom of omniscience, has no hope for their ripening.

"Further, householder, a householder bodhisattva who lives at home lives a celibate life and is pure. He does not give rise to desire even in his mind, let alone engage in sexual union or in intercourse through what is not the proper organ.

"Further, householder, a householder bodhisattva who lives at home, without touching the flawless certainty of the right path, goes to an empty dwelling and enters into absorption in the four meditative concentrations, accomplished by means of skillful means.

"Further, householder, a householder bodhisattva who lives at home strives to bring happiness to all sentient beings, and exerts diligence to go forth to liberation through the Perfection of Wisdom.

"Further, householder, householder bodhisattvas who live at home uphold the holy Dharma and also establish others in the genuine Dharma.

"Householder, a householder bodhisattva who lives at home and possesses these five qualities trains in the training of one who has gone forth."

Then the householder Ugra said this to the Blessed One: "Blessed One, I will act according to the command of the Tathāgatas. I will train in the training of one who has gone forth. I will also enter into such sameness of phenomena as this."

Then, at that time, the Blessed One smiled. It is the nature of things that whenever the buddhas, the blessed ones, smile, at that time light rays of many colors, of various colors, stream forth from the Blessed One's mouth: colors such as blue, yellow, red, white, crimson, crystal and silver. Having filled infinite and boundless world systems with their radiance, they rose up as far as the world of Brahmā, then turned back, circled the Blessed One three times, and vanished into the crown of the Blessed One's head.

Then the venerable Ānanda, through the power of the Buddha, rose from his seat, draped his upper robe over one shoulder, and placed his right knee on the ground. Bowing toward the Blessed One with palms joined, he said this to the Blessed One: "Blessed One, the Tathāgata does not smile without cause or without condition. What is the cause of your smiling? What is the condition?"

When he had asked this, the Blessed One said to the venerable Ānanda: "Ānanda, did you see this householder Ugra make offerings to the Tathāgata and roar the lion's roar for the sake of accomplishing the Dharma?"

He replied, "Blessed One, I saw it. Sugata, I saw it."

The Blessed One said, "Ānanda, this householder Ugra will serve all the tathāgatas who will appear in this Good Eon. He will honor them with respect and with every kind of offering. He will also uphold the holy Dharma. Always remaining a householder, he will abide in the training of one who has gone forth. He will also make the awakening of the Tathāgata flourish."

Then the venerable Ānanda said this to the householder Ugra: "Householder, for what cause and what condition do you delight in living at home and dwelling in the dust?"

Ugra said, "Venerable Ānanda, in the dust there is not the slightest dust. Being endowed with great compassion, I have no hope for my own happiness. Venerable Ānanda, though a bodhisattva is tormented by every suffering, he

endures it and does not abandon sentient beings."

When he had said this, the Blessed One said to the venerable Ānanda: "Ānanda, this householder Ugra, abiding on the householder's ground, will bring very many sentient beings to maturity in this Good Eon, which a bodhisattva who has gone forth could not do even in a thousand eons, or in many hundreds of thousands of eons. Why is that? Ānanda, the qualities that this householder has are not found even in a thousand bodhisattvas who have gone forth."

Then the venerable Ānanda said this to the Blessed One:

"Blessed One, what is the name of this Dharma discourse? How should it be remembered?"

The Blessed One said, "Therefore, Ānanda, remember this Dharma discourse as The Questions of Ugra. Remember it also as Accomplishing the Training of Householders and Renunciants. Remember it also as The Chapter on Serving the Teacher with Superior Intention.

"Ānanda, as soon as one hears this Dharma discourse, one fully gains the qualities of a bodhisattva, diligence, and many dharmas. It is not so for one who, with weak diligence, keeps the holy life for a hundred eons. Therefore, Ānanda, one who wishes to arouse diligence in oneself for this, wishes to encourage others in diligence, wishes to abide oneself in the sameness of all good qualities, and wishes to establish others in the sameness of all good qualities should listen to this Dharma discourse, master it, read it, and teach it extensively and correctly to others as well.

"Ānanda, I entrust this Dharma discourse to you so that it may be taught extensively and correctly again and again. Why is that? Because the Tathāgata has explained that all good qualities are included in this Dharma discourse.

"Ānanda, whatever bodhisattva remains inseparable from this Dharma discourse will not be separated from the appearance of buddhas. Ānanda, whatever bodhisattva is never parted from hearing, holding, or reading this Dharma discourse will not be separated from the appearance of buddhas or from seeing all the buddhas. Why is that? Because, Ānanda, the Tathāgata has correctly explained that all good qualities are included in this Dharma discourse, and that all the qualities of the path of accomplishing the training are included in this Dharma discourse.

"Ānanda, sons or daughters of good family who seek perfect, complete awakening should cross even a great trichiliocosm world system filled with fire in order to hear this Dharma discourse and master it. Ānanda, one should make a picture of nothing less than a great trichiliocosm world system filled with the seven kinds of precious things, offer it to the teacher, and hear this Dharma discourse and master it.

"Ānanda, suppose a bodhisattva has built a separate stupa of precious substances for each of the buddhas, the blessed ones of the past, and honored them with every kind of offering; has likewise served the buddhas, the blessed ones of the present, together with their saṅghas of śrāvakas, with every comfort for as long as they live; and has pledged himself as servant and disciple of the buddhas, the blessed ones of the future, and of the bodhisattvas, and has served them. Even so, if he does not take up this Dharma discourse, does not retain it, does not read it, does not master it, does not enter into it, and does not abide in this practice, then, Ānanda, that bodhisattva has not made offerings to the tathāgatas of the past, the future, and the present.

"Ānanda, if a bodhisattva hears this Dharma discourse and masters it, and, so that the holy Dharma may long endure and the lineage of the buddhas may not be broken, teaches it extensively and correctly to others as well and abides in this practice, then, Ānanda, that bodhisattva has made offerings to the buddhas, the blessed ones of the past, the future, and the present. He has also served them with reverence."

When the Blessed One had spoken thus, the venerable Ānanda, the householder Ugra, those monks, those bodhisattvas, and the world with its gods, humans, asuras, and gandharvas rejoiced and praised what the Blessed One had said.

This completes The Questions of the Noble Ugra, the nineteenth chapter of the Dharma discourse in one hundred thousand chapters, the Noble Great Heap of Jewels.

It was translated, edited, and finalized by the Indian preceptor Surendrabodhi and the chief editor and translator, the monk Yeshé Dé.

Here is the Heap of Jewels, volume Ca.

Translator's Notes

• Several householders' names could not be identified with confidence and are translated by meaning: Lover of Joy, Lover of Fame, Joy-Maker, Delighting in Conduct, and Delighting in Truth. Sudatta, Yaśodatta, Sudhana and Nāgaśrī are reconstructed from standard renderings.
• "The flawless state" renders □□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□, most likely the technical samyaktvaniyāma, the assured entry into the path of the noble ones.
• "Living creatures and beings" renders the pair srog chags and 'byung po (Skt. prāṇin and bhūta), which here means living beings in general, not the class of spirits. The phrase "not rejecting the vehicles of the śrāvakas and pratyekabuddhas" follows the Tibetan as it stands; other versions of this sūtra may express the point differently. "A closed teacher's fist" is the stock image for a teacher who holds back part of the teaching.
• "Even in thought" renders □□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□, where □□□ ("nine") makes no sense; the reading followed is that the bodhisattva should not indulge desire even mentally. Two evident slips are read as intended: □□□□□□□□□□□□ as □□□□□□□□□□□□□□□ ("perfection"), and □□□□□□□□□□ as □□□□□□□□□□□□ ("speak of discipline"). The permission to give liquor reflects this sūtra's teaching that a lay bodhisattva's perfection of giving may override the fifth precept, provided he gives with the intention of leading the recipient toward mindfulness.
• The four items "giving, self-taming, perfect restraint, and observance" likely reflect Sanskrit dāna, dama, saṃyama, and niyama. The Tibetan □□□□□, rendered "observance," is uncertain. "Takes the wrong course" renders the four agatis, the wrong courses taken out of desire, aversion, fear, and delusion. In "ruins whatever has come into being," the sense of □□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□ is somewhat uncertain and may reflect a play on the Sanskrit word for home.
• The third item in the fourth set of perceptions, rendered "emerging from clinging to what is ignoble," is somewhat obscure in the Tibetan and could also be read as the perception that the beggar or the request arises from clinging to what is ignoble. In "indifferent toward the thing and giving it away," the text's □□□□ is read as □□□□, "giving away."
• The term rendered "stocks" (khri mon) is rare and its precise sense is uncertain; it evidently names some instrument of confinement, paired here with killing and bondage. Likewise "trap" for khog tse is a contextual rendering alongside snare and net, and "bottomless depth" for gting is an interpretation of a terse term.
• The fifth group of "three" perceptions in fact lists five items (grief, lamentation, suffering, unhappiness, agitation); it is translated as the Tibetan gives it. □□□□□ in the summary is read as a variant of □□□□□□, "strife," rather than "hearth." Several similes are rendered by their most likely sense: □□□□□, □□□□□□□ and □□□□□□ as "flood," "yoke" and "knot," echoing the standard categories of afflictions (ogha, yoga, grantha); □□□□□□ as "keen blade"; □□□□□□□□□ as "fetter"; and □□□□□□□□□□□□ as "a demoness who steals vitality," a class of being, not Hārītī.
• The phrase rendered "brings deliverance" (literally "is accompanied by emergence") is somewhat uncertain; it may instead mean that the teaching allows for lapses occurring. The purpose clause "to safeguard life in the countless buddha fields" is rendered literally; its exact sense in this list is not fully clear.
• In the pair "conduct that involves punishment / free of punishment," □□□□ is taken in its ordinary sense of "punishment, penalty" rather than the doctrinal sense of "annihilation," since the context (alongside weapons and fear) clearly requires it.
• "Full of vexation" renders □□□□□□□□□, a rare term whose exact sense is uncertain; it seems to denote agitation or strife. "Offers an opening" renders □□□□□□, presumably meaning that household life gives Māra and the afflictions an opportunity. "The king's retainers" renders □□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□, whose precise meaning is also uncertain.
• "Those who uphold the Mātṛkā" renders □□□□□□□□□□□. Here □□□□ is the mātṛkā, the doctrinal summaries or matrices associated with the Abhidharma, beside the Vinaya and the Bodhisattva Piṭaka. It is not the class of goddesses given in the glossary. The phrase □□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□

("heat by robes") makes little sense as written. It is translated as "satisfied with robes," reading □□□□□ or a similar word. The ascetic who wears rag robes is the one being described. "The genuine, flawless state" (□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□) most likely refers to samyaktvaniyāma, the secure entry onto the noble path.
• The bodhisattva's name, rendered literally as "Completely Pure in All Conduct," could not be identified with confidence; a Sanskrit form along the lines of Sarvacaryāviśuddha is possible but unattested here. The four lineages of the noble ones are usually contentment with robes, almsfood and lodging, plus delight in abandonment. This text first lists contentment with medicine, and the passage that follows takes up delight in abandonment. Ugra's closing question concerns how the homage laypeople pay to a monastic bodhisattva can be made fruitful rather than empty.
• "Putrid medicine" renders □□□□□□□□□□, the traditional fourth monastic support (Skt. pūtimuktabhaiṣajya), medicine steeped in fermented urine. The list of ten benefits of wilderness dwelling, as the Tibetan stands, contains eleven clauses; translated as written. The phrase rendered "the benefits of the merits of work performed" is uncertain in sense.
• The list of fears is prose in the Tibetan; it is set out one item per line only to make the long repeated refrain easier to follow when read aloud. The term rendered "hindrances" in "obscurations, hindrances and outbursts of affliction" is uncertain in its exact technical sense here.
• The list of terms denying a self in the body follows the standard Sanskrit series ātman, sattva, jīva, jantu, poṣa, puruṣa, pudgala, manuja, mānava; the last two (Tibetan "born of Manu" and "child of Manu") are rendered literally as "one born of Manu" and "child of Manu." "Wilderness" renders araṇya, the secluded forest dwelling away from villages.
• "Acceptance even toward omniscience itself" renders a terse phrase; the sense appears to be that he patiently accepts, or is receptive to, omniscience. "Ascetic qualities" renders the term for the dhutaguṇas.
• In the phrase "gain, honor, and fame," the Tibetan has the word for "verse." This reflects the standard Sanskrit compound lābha-satkāra-śloka, in which śloka means "fame, renown." The Tibetan translators rendered it with the other sense of śloka, "verse," so it is translated here as "fame."
• "The flawless certainty of the right path" renders □□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□, understood as the samyaktvaniyāma, the fixed entry into the śrāvaka path toward arhatship, which a bodhisattva avoids "touching" so as not to fall into the lesser vehicle while practicing the concentrations.
• The last line is a volume marker added by the editors of the Kangyur, not part of the sutra. It states that this is volume Ca of the Ratnakūṭa section.

Colophon

This is an AI-generated translation from the AI Stupa project. It was produced by a careful, doctrine-aware process aiming at a high degree of accuracy, but it has not been reviewed by a human translator and may contain errors. It is offered as a provisional translation for those texts of the Tibetan Buddhist canon that have not yet received an authoritative human translation. Where a published translation exists — above all from 84000: Translating the Words of the Buddha (84000.co) — that translation is definitive and should be preferred; please consult it instead. These translations are released into the public domain (CC0) in the spirit of spreading the Dharma to all corners of the earth.

Just as the Bodhi tree now standing at Bodh Gayā neither is nor is not the same tree beneath which the Buddha attained awakening, so too this stupa is intended as the next generation of

stupa — dependently arising according to the conditions of its environment, and ceaselessly proclaiming the Dharma for the benefit of all sentient beings.

May whoever encounters these words derive great benefit.